Sample Emails

This document provides sample emails to help you draft messages to your letter signers and any others involved in your petition process. You may modify or disregard them as you see fit. They are simply meant to offer guidance on tone and content.

1a. Requesting a Support Letter

Subject - Request for a Support Letter for a U.S. Permanent Residency Petition

Dear [Name],

I hope this message finds you well. My name is [Your Name], and I am currently a [Your Position] at [Your current institution]. I am writing to respectfully request your support for my application for permanent residency in the United States.

[Insert one of the following or personalize as needed:]

- We met at [Conference] in [Year], where we had a valuable discussion following my presentation about [Topic].
- I've noticed that you have cited some of my publications in your own work, for example, [Your paper being cited]
- Although we have not met personally, I have long followed your research, which closely aligns with my interests. I am truly impressed by your contributions to the field.

I earned my [Degree name] from [University], and have worked in the field of [Field] for [Number] years. Throughout my career, I have published numerous papers in esteemed journals, including [Journal] and [Journal]. To continue my research and professional work in the U.S., I am applying for permanent residency in the U.S. As a respected expert in this field, your support would be highly valuable for my petition.

With your permission, I would be happy to provide a draft of the support letter for your review and approval.

Attached is my current CV for your reference. Please do not hesitate to contact me if you have any questions or require further information. I truly appreciate your time and consideration.

Sincerely,
[Your Name]

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1b. Sending a drafted support letter to the signer

Subject - Re: Request for a Support Letter for a U.S. Permanent Residency Petition

Dear [Name],

I hope this message finds you well. As you may recall, I previously reached out to request your support for my U.S. permanent residency petition. Attached is a draft of the support letter and a revision guide for your review. Please feel free to make any changes you believe are appropriate.

If you wish to revise the draft, my attorney has asked that you kindly send your edits in a Word document, with the "track changes" function on. This allows them to ensure the final version includes the most helpful and accurate information for my petition. They have also noted that certain elements may weaken a letter, such as:

- speculative language about my work, e.g., using words like 'potential', 'possible', 'may', 'probably', etc.
- qualifying language, e.g., 'young researcher', 'early career professional', 'rising star', etc.
- inclusion of your personal publication counts and/or citation metrics

If you are comfortable with the letter, I would greatly appreciate it if you could add your professional letterhead, date the letter, and sign it with an original handwritten signature or a verified digital signature.

Your support is very important to me, and I am truly grateful for your time and assistance. Please do not hesitate to reach out if you need any additional information.

Thank you once again.

Sincerely,
[Your Name]

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1c. Reminder to a support letter signer

Subject - Re: Request for a Support Letter for a U.S. Permanent Residency Petition

Dear [Name],

I hope this message finds you well. I am following up regarding the support letter for my U.S. permanent residency petition, which is scheduled to be filed soon. I understand that your time is valuable, and I truly appreciate your willingness to assist with this important step for me.

At your convenience, I would be grateful if you could kindly review and sign the letter I previously sent. If you have any questions or comments, please feel free to let me know, and I would be more than happy to help.

Thank you again for your generous support. It means a lot to me and plays a key role in my petition and future career. I look forward to hearing from you.

Sincerely,
[Your Name]

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2. Requesting a letter from the registrar's office of your university

Subject - Request for Official Degree Confirmation Letter

Dear Registrar's Office,

I hope this message finds you well. I am writing to request an official letter confirming the completion and conferral date of my [Degree name] degree at [University name].

I would appreciate it if the letter could include the following information:

1. Degree awarded
2. Field of study
3. My dates of attendance in the program
4. Degree conferral date

I would also appreciate it if the letter could be:

1. Printed on official university letterhead
2. Signed by a representative of the Registrar's Office and/or stamped by the Registrar's Office

For your convenience, I have attached a letter template that may be used as a reference. Please let me know if there are any forms I need to complete or if additional information is required to process this request.

Thank you very much for your time and assistance.

Sincerely,
[Your Full Name]
[Your Student ID Number, if applicable]

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3. Requesting a peer review testimonial letter

Note: This letter should not be necessary if you can provide alternative peer review evidence, such as copies of the initial invitation email and the thank you email.

Subject - Request for Testimonial Letter Confirming Peer Review Work

Dear [Name],

I hope this message finds you well. My name is [Your Name], and I have served as a peer reviewer for [Journal] at your invitation. I am reaching out to respectfully request your support for my U.S. permanent residency petition, which I am currently preparing.

As part of my petition, it would be very helpful to include a testimonial letter confirming my contributions to the field of [Field] through peer review. Specifically, the letter would briefly state that you invited me to review manuscripts based on my expertise and that I completed the work.

With your permission, I would be happy to provide a letter draft for your review and signature.

Your support would mean a lot to me at this important stage in my career. Please do not hesitate to contact me if you need any additional information.

Thank you very much for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,
[Your Name]

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